

Even Step

The December 2026 CEA link — the proposal in ten minutes

For managers · 26 weeks · code ES-26-T5 · the full proposal sheet has the detail

The short version

Four numbers

9 of 9	35h	0	26
December rules met	**contracted hours a week**	**avoidable fatigue warnings**	**people on the link**
today 4	Mon–Sat average	fixed rota · today 4	today 20

Every December rule met — and no avoidable fatigue warnings in the fixed rota.

The staffing you asked for

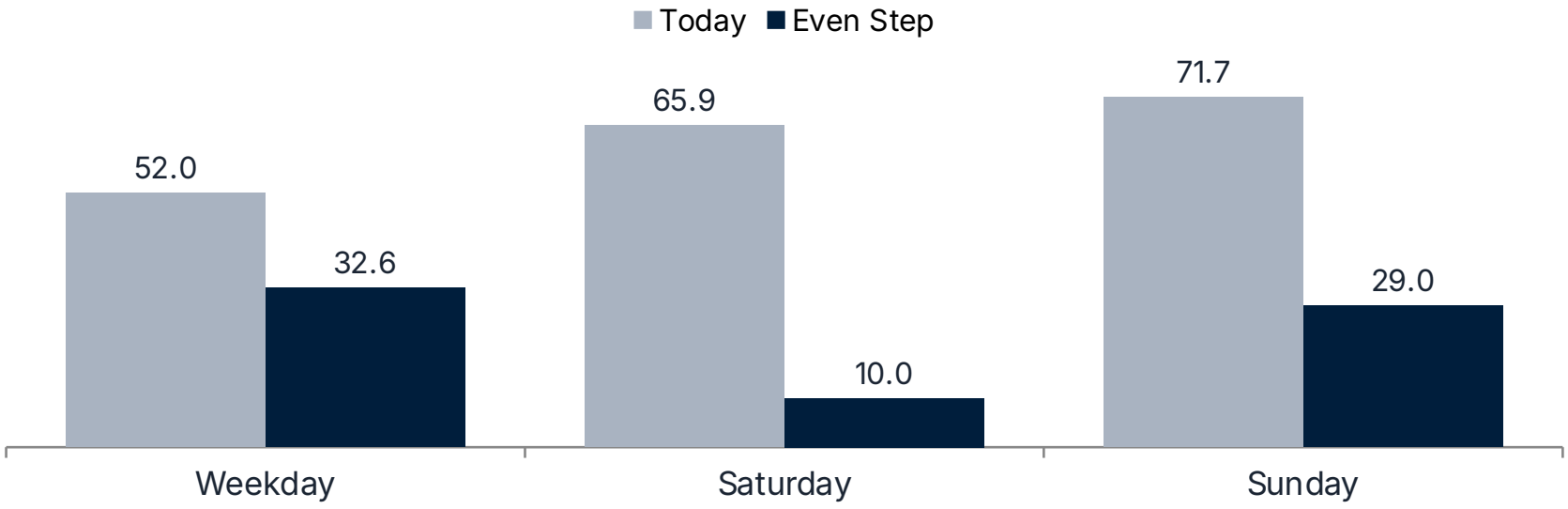
Weekday · Saturday · Sunday

	Today	Even Step
On duty each day	11–12 · 10 · 8	**15 · 14 · 10**
At the open (06:20, Sunday 07:15)	4 · 4 · 3	**5 · 5 · 4**
Still on after 22:00	4 · 2 · 3	**7 · 5 · 5**
Through to the close	2 · 2 · 3	**3 · 3 · 3**
Fewest rostered on the floor	2 · 2 · 2	**3 · 3 · 3**

Every level met on every day — and the ticket office staffed in pairs, including Sundays.

People where the trains are

How far the floor staffing is from the shape of the December timetable — lower is better



Closer to the December pattern every day, much closer at the weekend. The score: hour by hour, how far staffing sits from the trains; 0 would track them exactly.

People and hours

What it takes to run

	Today	Even Step
People on the link	20	**26**
Contracted hours a week	35h	**35h**
Cover weeks (for leave and sickness)	4 in 20 (1 in 5)	**5 in 26 (1 in 5.2)**
People needed each Sunday (overtime)	8	**10**

Six more people, 35 hours a week on average; Sunday overtime 83h 30m a week across the link (today 68h 15m).

Fatigue checks

Against the Office of Rail and Road's good-practice list and the rail industry's own checks

	Today	Even Step
Avoidable fatigue warnings, fixed rota	4 (up to 5)	**0 (up to 1)**
Most days in a row (limit 13)	7 (up to 9)	**5 (up to 7)**
Shortest rest between shifts (limit 12h)	12h 30m	**14h 35m**
Longest shift	9h 10m	**9h 00m**

Rest and run limits met with room to spare; no avoidable fatigue warnings in the fixed rota.

Why Even Step?

What all three shortlisted links give, what this one adds, and what it costs

- ✓ All three shortlisted: all 9 December rules; no avoidable fatigue warning, fixed rota
- ✓ All three shortlisted: 14 full weekends off a year (today 10), at most 5 weeks apart
- ✓ All three shortlisted: no shift over 9 hours, and every closing shift shorter
- ✓ This one adds: Mon–Sat, no shift over 8h 30m and every early a time worked today
- ✓ 8 of 13 shift times worked today; 5 new, 3 of them shorter versions of today’s lates
- – This one costs: the longest weekday lates (8h 27m), the weakest weekday fit

All three: two more Saturdays a year, four weeks off for 15 days’ leave, and late finishes — 42 a year at 23:00 or later (today 39), 94 at 22:00 or later (today 78).

What colleagues will notice

The good and the not so good — the colleague presentation shows both

Likely to welcome

- 14 full weekends off a year (today 10)
- At most 5 days in a row, fixed rota (today 7)
- Longest shift Mon–Sat 8h 30m, not 9h 10m
- Every closing shift 30–60 minutes shorter
- 8 of the 13 shift times already worked

Likely to worry about

- Late finishes: 42 a year at 23:00 or later (today 39), 94 at 22:00 or later (today 78)
- 5 new shift times to learn
- Two more Saturdays a year (28, today 26)
- 14 days' leave: at best 28 days off, not 30
- Four weeks off needs 15 days' leave, not 14

Expect late finishes to be the first question — the colleague deck answers it openly.

Where it stands

Three things settled, two decisions left, two points still open

- ✓ **December rules — confirmed**
  The nine December rules. Everything here is built on them.
- ✓ **26 people on the link — confirmed**
  Six more than today, with five cover weeks.
- ✓ **Sunday cover — confirmed**
  Ten on a Sunday — Sunday work stays overtime.
- ? **To decide: which link we use**
  Colleagues' views come first.
- ? **Then: who starts on which line**
  Who begins on which week. Open: the 13-day limit's written source; the FF19 reading.

Colleagues' views come first; the link is chosen after them, then who starts where.



The detail

- Every week of the link, day by day
- Staff on duty hour by hour, against the trains
- Every December rule and fatigue check, worked through

All in the eight-page proposal sheet · Even Step · ES-26-T5